## ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 1

Chapters 5–8: **The World of Limitless Possibilities; Nine Gold Medals, Twin Melodies; A Friend Found in Music, Carrier of Words; Words (poem), Follow That Dream; the poem on self-belief** | Class 9 English | Maximum Marks: 50

### SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 15 × 1 = 15

| Q. | Correct Option | Brief Reasoning |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | **(c)** hope and open choice | Opportunity. |
| 2 | **(c)** fears conflict but wants to follow her passion | Mixed feelings. |
| 3 | **(d)** show his dedication in harsh conditions | Hardship. |
| 4 | **(b)** realistic | Realism. |
| 5 | **(b)** it can overcome physical limits | Result. |
| 6 | **(d)** it shows rather than tells the theme | Performance. |
| 7 | **(d)** Khetaram delivers post in a desert area. | Fact. |
| 8 | **(c)** to deal well with a challenge | Idiom. |
| 9 | **(c)** should | Duty. |
| 10 | **(d)** Nabin asked if she would play for him. | Question to statement. |
| 11 | **(d)** Many letters have been delivered by him. | Have been delivered. |
| 12 | **(b)** Mother asked if I would try again. | Question. |
| 13 | **(b)** inspire readers through lived experience | Purpose. |
| 14 | **(c)** attachment to classical purity | Tradition. |
| 15 | **(d)** many cannot read and trust him with private news | Trust. |

### SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 5 × 2 = 10

| Q. | Expected Answer / Value Points | Marks |
|---|---|---|
| 16 | She believes ability is about mind and effort (1) so she focuses on what she can do (1). | 1+1 |
| 17 | The audience fears discovery (1) and wonders how Nabin will react (1). | 1+1 |
| 18 | He brings news that affects families (1) and sometimes reads private letters aloud (1). | 1+1 |
| 19 | She urges Ming to follow her dream (1) yet lists effort and sacrifice she must expect (1). | 1+1 |
| 20 | By providing equal access (1) and changing attitudes (1). | 1+1 |

### SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 5 × 3 = 15

| Q. | Expected Answer / Value Points | Marks |
|---|---|---|
| 21 | By stressing her achievements (1). By letting her speak of struggles (1). By ending with advice (1). | 1+1+1 |
| 22 | Nabin's fear is real (1). Shruti's wish is natural (1). Both are portrayed lovingly (1). | 1+1+1 |
| 23 | By describing his hardships (1). By showing his honesty (1). By presenting villagers' trust (1). | 1+1+1 |
| 24 | Dreams need time (1). They may need giving up comforts (1). Sacrifice shows seriousness (1). | 1+1+1 |
| | **OR:** Questions invite reflection (1). Direct answers make readers feel addressed (1). It adds a personal touch (1). | 1+1+1 |
| 25 | It links old and new (1). It uses classical roots (1). So it carries tradition forward (1). | 1+1+1 |
| | **OR:** To match the simple setting (1). To honour the subject (1). To reach all readers (1). | 1+1+1 |

### SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

| Q. | Expected Answer / Value Points | Marks |
|---|---|---|
| 26 | Her illness (1). Her choice to focus on possibility (1). Success in sport (1). Strengths from struggle (1). Inspiration to others (1). | 2+2+1 |
| | **OR:** Nabin's refusal to listen (1). Shruti's fear of speaking (1). Leela's listening (1). The performance as listening (1). Resolution through listening (1). | 2+2+1 |
| 27 | Hard conditions (1). Dedication (1). Trust of villagers (1). Little recognition (1). The writer's tribute (1). | 2+2+1 |

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| | **OR:** Optimism in the call to follow dreams (1). Realism in cost and effort (1). Support network (1). Flexibility (1). Balanced message (1). | 2+2+1 |

**Evaluator's note:** Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

MASTERMIND

## ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 2

Chapters 5–8: **The World of Limitless Possibilities; Nine Gold Medals, Twin Melodies; A Friend Found in Music, Carrier of Words; Words (poem), Follow That Dream; the poem on self-belief** | Class 9 English | Maximum Marks: 50

### SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 15 × 1 = 15

| Q. | Correct Option | Brief Reasoning |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | **(a)** encouraging yet cautious | Balanced. |
| 2 | **(d)** earnest and encouraging | Positive. |
| 3 | **(d)** Conflict rises and then is resolved | Classic structure. |
| 4 | **(a)** Khetaram deserves our highest respect. | Opinion. |
| 5 | **(c)** sender's address, date, salutation, body, closing | Format. |
| 6 | **(c)** Many barriers have been broken by athletes. | Have been broken. |
| 7 | **(b)** should | Duty. |
| 8 | **(a)** He asked her where she lived. | Wh-question. |
| 9 | **(a)** should | Advice. |
| 10 | **(d)** they display strength and skill publicly | Visibility. |
| 11 | **(d)** mediator | Bridges the two. |
| 12 | **(d)** carries a relative's care | Emotional value. |
| 13 | **(c)** action and persistence | Action. |
| 14 | **(d)** values one another over the prize | They care for each other. |
| 15 | **(b)** set mood and cue action | Direction. |

### SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 5 × 2 = 10

| Q. | Expected Answer / Value Points | Marks |
|---|---|---|
| 16 | Father and daughter are twins in love of music (1). Their styles differ but harmonise (1). | 1+1 |
| 17 | Letters hold feelings (1) so he carries hopes and relationships (1). | 1+1 |
| 18 | A letter allows careful thought (1) and can be kept and re-read (1). | 1+1 |
| 19 | It confirms the value of the act (1) and shows society's approval of kindness (1). | 1+1 |
| 20 | It makes the voice personal (1) so music seems a close companion (1). | 1+1 |

### SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 5 × 3 = 15

| Q. | Expected Answer / Value Points | Marks |
|---|---|---|
| 21 | She knows the cost of effort (1). She has seen dreams change (1). Her advice carries authority (1). | 1+1+1 |
| 22 | Dr Malik is an athlete who won a silver medal (1). 'Who' joins the sentences (1). It makes a relative clause (1). | 1+1+1 |
| 23 | Although Nabin loved tradition, he accepted fusion (1). 'Although' makes the first clause subordinate (1). Contrast is shown (1). | 1+1+1 |
| 24 | The postman who serves the village is honest (1). 'Who' joins the clauses (1). It avoids repetition (1). | 1+1+1 |
| | **OR:** If you work hard, you will succeed (1). Imperative becomes an if clause (1). First conditional (1). | 1+1+1 |
| 25 | She says mind matters more than body (1). Mental strength helped training (1). It helped overcome social hurdles (1). | 1+1+1 |
| | **OR:** It reveals his own rebellion (1). It shows the pattern repeating (1). It makes him reflect (1). | 1+1+1 |

### SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

| Q. | Expected Answer / Value Points | Marks |
|---|---|---|
| 26 | The title promises a contest (1). 'Nine gold' broadens meaning (1). Ending shows shared joy (1). Irony of winning by losing (1). Message stays (1). | 2+2+1 |
| | **OR:** Theme (1). Devices (1). Language and rhythm (1). Mood (1). Personal response (1). | 2+2+1 |
| 27 | Theme (1). Devices (1). Language (1). Tone (1). Personal response (1). | 2+2+1 |
| | **OR:** Theme (1). Devices (1). Language (1). Mood (1). Personal response (1). | 2+2+1 |

**Evaluator's note:** Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

MASTERMIND

# THE MASTERMIND COACHING CLASSES

CBSE / RBSE • NURSERY – CLASS XII • JAIPUR

Road No. 5, VKIA, Jaipur — 9887258679

## ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 3

Chapters 5–8: **The World of Limitless Possibilities; Nine Gold Medals, Twin Melodies; A Friend Found in Music, Carrier of Words; Words (poem), Follow That Dream; the poem on self-belief** | Class 9 English | Maximum Marks: 50

### SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 15 × 1 = 15

| Q. | Correct Option | Brief Reasoning |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | **(c)** power to hurt and heal | Power. |
| 2 | **(a)** when we try difficult things | Growth. |
| 3 | **(d)** She asked if I was ready. | Question to statement. |
| 4 | **(d)** imperative | A command. |
| 5 | **(c)** must | Duty. |
| 6 | **(b)** Dreams are built by effort. | Are built. |
| 7 | **(a)** wants focus on strengths | Positive framing. |
| 8 | **(b)** hears the group play | Experience changes him. |
| 9 | **(c)** a lifeline to the outside world | Lifeline. |
| 10 | **(a)** a shared effort | Shared. |
| 11 | **(a)** a turning point | Triggers action. |
| 12 | **(c)** a signal for action or speech | Cue. |
| 13 | **(a)** cannot be called back | Irreversibility. |
| 14 | **(c)** phrasal verb meaning to take action | Phrasal verb. |
| 15 | **(b)** yet | Contrast. |

### SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 5 × 2 = 10

| Q. | Expected Answer / Value Points | Marks |
|---|---|---|
| 16 | They make an abstract idea visible (1) and help us feel the force of words (1). | 1+1 |
| 17 | Commands sound urgent (1) and speak directly to the reader (1). | 1+1 |
| 18 | It gives purpose and community (1) and proves their strengths to society (1). | 1+1 |
| 19 | He experiences the music himself (1) and Leela reminds him of his own past (1). | 1+1 |
| 20 | It is essential for survival (1) because it connects people and money to remote homes (1). | 1+1 |

### SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 5 × 3 = 15

| Q. | Expected Answer / Value Points | Marks |
|---|---|---|
| 21 | He serves remote homes (1). He helps the unlettered (1). He links isolated communities (1). | 1+1+1 |
| 22 | She lists costs (1). She mentions the need for help (1). She speaks of possible changes (1). | 1+1+1 |
| 23 | The race begins (1). The fall creates tension (1). The return of the runners is the climax (1). | 1+1+1 |
| 24 | He fears loss of purity (1). He assumes it is noise (1). Pride in his tradition blocks him (1). | 1+1+1 |
| | **OR:** Words connect people (1). They carry feelings (1). Careful words keep bridges safe (1). | 1+1+1 |
| 25 | Mastery takes time (1). Patience is needed (1). Time tests commitment (1). | 1+1+1 |
| | **OR:** She is not only brave but also kind (1). Correlative conjunctions pair ideas (1). Stress is on both qualities (1). | 1+1+1 |

### SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

| Q. | Expected Answer / Value Points | Marks |
|---|---|---|
| 26 | Society's view limits (1). Dr Malik's own view empowers (1). Sport reshapes both (1). Inclusion benefits all (1). Call to change (1). | 2+2+1 |
| | **OR:** Exposition (1). Rising conflict (1). Climax at the performance (1). Falling action (1). Resolution (1). | 2+2+1 |
| 27 | Reaches the unreachable (1). Money orders (1). Letters (1). Help for the unlettered (1). National integration (1). | 2+2+1 |
| | **OR:** Follow your dream (1). Count the cost (1). Work and sacrifice (1). Seek support (1). Your choice and reason (1). | 2+2+1 |

**Evaluator's note:** Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

MASTERMIND